Part Two:
Understanding Yourself

Session Two: **Understanding yourself**

Introduction

In order to understand change, it is important for young people to think about factors in their environment that affect their behaviour. This session aims to help young people understand their roles as part of a wider world and to think about the impact people who share their world have on them.

The different activities here may be helpful for the facilitator to gain insight into how best to support the young person. You may wish to choose the activities or elements of the activities that seem most suitable to the young person you are working with.

Aims

1. To help the young person understand that psychology can be useful in understanding behaviour

2. To help the young person develop an awareness of the people and environment surrounding them

3. To help the young person understand that change occurs within a context

4. To help the young person identify key people who have an impact on their life

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Activity 2a: **Psychology… What does it mean?**

This activity is designed to help young people understand the contribution psychology can make in helping them understand their own behaviour and that of others.

You will need

- ☑ Activity sheet 2a, *Psychology… What does it mean?*
- ☑ Pen/pencil

What to do

- Ask the young person/people what they think psychology is. If you wish to record ideas, use Activity Sheet 2a. Discuss the responses

- Explain that psychology is a way of trying to understand human beings and how we behave. If we understand a little about psychology, we can learn more about behaviour

- Explain that the other activities that you are about to introduce enable the young person to find out more about themselves in relation to the world around them

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Activity 2b: **My world**

Aim
To help the pupil develop an awareness of their environment and the people surrounding them and gain an understanding that change occurs within a context.

You will need

- ☑ Up to four copies of activity sheet 2b (i) *My World*.
- ☑ Activity sheet 2b (ii) *My World - Cards* contains four sets of cards (blank, spot and grid). Ideally these would be cut out in advance of the session.
- ☑ Scissors and glue
- ☑ Coloured pens or pencils

What to do

- Introduce the young person to Activity Sheet 2b (i). Asking them to talk through whom they see as family. What do they see as their outside world? Is it school, work, where they live etc? You may like to record their responses.

- Use the three cards from Activity Sheet 2b (ii). Get the young person to look at the cards and choose one that firstly represents themselves, secondly the family and thirdly the outside world. Ask them to place (or stick) one set of cards the cards on the diagram

- If you have stuck the cards on, take a fresh activity sheet 2b(i). This time, ask the young person to choose a situation that is relevant to them (e.g. going out, getting into trouble at school). Write the situation on the new sheet

- Ask the young person to keep this situation in mind and ask them again to choose cards representing themselves, the family and the outside world

- When they have placed the cards in the circle, ask them what the cards mean to them and why they have placed them where they have

- Repeat the activity for other situations, as appropriate. The young person may like to choose other shapes or shades to represent themselves, the family and the outside world and can add these to the circles using coloured pens or pencils

- Discuss with the young person how family members and the outside world affect our behaviour and make us see things in different ways. Also discuss how these can be both positive and negative

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Activity 2c: **People who affect my life**

Aim

To help the young person to identify key people who have an impact on their life.

You will need

- ☑ Activity sheet 2c, *People who affect my life.*
- ☑ Pen/pencil

What to do

- Using Activity Sheet 2c, ask the young person to draw themselves or write their name in the middle circle. In the circles around, ask them to draw people who have an impact on their life. These may be groups of people (i.e. 'my friends at the youth centre') rather than individuals.

- Talk about why the young person has chosen to put different groups/individuals in the different circles.

- Talk about the effect the people in the diagram have on the young person's life.

Plenary

Ask the young person if the exercises have been useful in helping them to learn about themselves. Who and what influence how they live their life? In what way might the information be useful to them?

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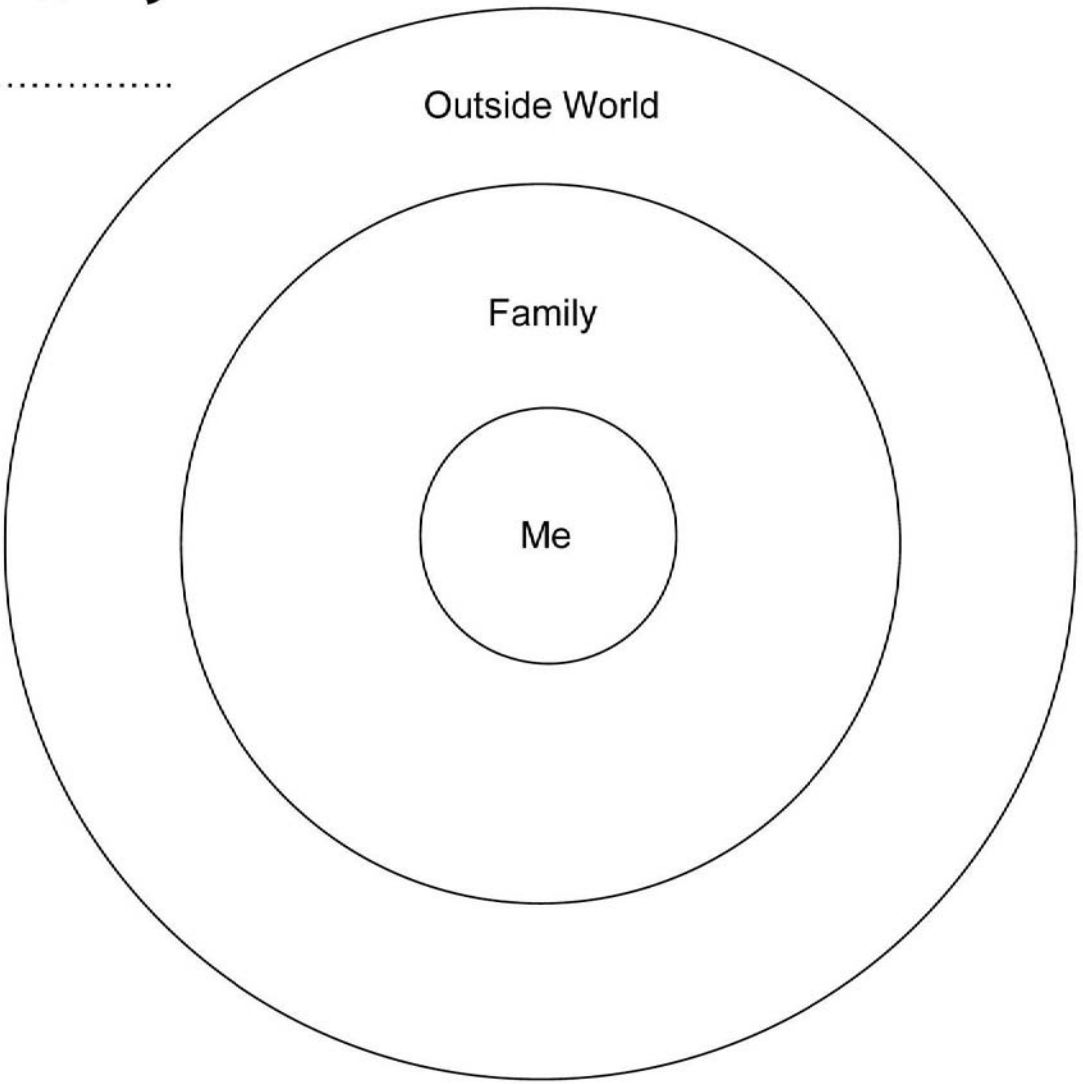
Activity Sheet 2a

Psychology…
What does it mean?

Activity Sheet 2b (i): **My world**

Situation……..



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Activity Sheet 2b (ii): **My world - cards**

Activity Sheet 2c: **People who affect my life**